BAKLAVA



YIELD	ACTIVE TIME	OVEN	UNIT WEIGHT
12 triangular pieces	**45 min**	**320F / 160C, 1 h 30 min**	**80 g**

ENERGY COST	PRICE
$5.16 (120 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)	**$4**

DETAILS

- Tags: vegetarian

INGREDIENTS

450 g, one package	Phyllo dough
250 g	Butter
40 g	Olive oil
400 g	Walnuts, finely chopped
1 tbsp	Ground cinnamon
2 tbsp	Sugar, for the filling
2 tbsp	Unsweetened cocoa powder
1/4 tsp	Ground cloves
450 g	Sugar, for the syrup
360 g	Water, for the syrup
80 g	Honey
2 tbsp	Lemon juice, fresh
1	Orange peel
1	Cinnamon stick
1 to 2 tsp, optional, see Notes	Rose water

METHOD

1. Thaw the phyllo in the fridge overnight, then leave it an hour at room temperature before opening.
2. Syrup: bring sugar, water, honey, lemon juice, orange peel and the cinnamon stick to a boil, drop to medium and simmer 6 minutes. Cool completely to room temperature.
3. Filling: mix the walnuts, cinnamon, sugar, cocoa and cloves.
4. Heat the oven to 320F, upper and lower heat if you have it.
5. Melt the butter and stir in the olive oil. Keep it warm, since you will be brushing for a while.
6. Trim the phyllo to a 33 x 23 cm pan and keep the stack under a tea towel so it does not dry.
7. Count your sheets and divide them: 5 for the base, 3 between each of the filling layers, 7 on top. Adjust if your package has more than 24.
8. Brush the pan, lay the 5 base sheets, buttering each.
9. Scatter a fifth of the filling, then 3 buttered sheets. Repeat until the filling is used.
10. Finish with the remaining sheets, buttering each.
11. Cut into 3 strips, then into squares, then halve each square diagonally for 12 triangles.

12. Pour over the last of the butter, brush level, and flick a little water across the top.
13. Bake 1 h 30 min on the lowest rack, not the floor of the oven.
14. Ladle the cold syrup over the moment it leaves the oven. Cool to room temperature.

NOTES

Cold syrup onto hot baklava is the rule. Reversing it makes the pastry soggy.
Rose water option: stir 1 to 2 tsp into the syrup after it comes off the heat, not during the simmer, or the aroma boils off. Start at 1 tsp, since it turns perfumed fast.
Cocoa in a walnut filling is unusual and is what makes this version darker and less purely sweet.
The syrup is 450 g sugar to 360 g water, so slightly over saturation, which is why it sets rather than running out.
Keeps 2 weeks refrigerated, or at room temperature.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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